

What People use in the Industry

Ever wondered if you really need to use these expensive page layout software packages?

The newest versions of Microsoft Word and Photoshop are quite proficient when it comes to handling text and images and most of us can churn out pretty decent looking documents with them.

Even page layout professionals tend to use these to lay out simpler brochures and booklets. In the new release of Photoshop one can easily design and create brochures, pamphlets, visiting cards, memo's and also type in large amounts of text.

One of the things that Photoshop does lack, however, is the ability to flow text around the object, etc. Hence if you want to really do something special with your design you will require the additional flexibility of a specialist page layout tool. This is why professional designers would eventually choose to import the image objects into the page layout software and flow the text and manipulate elements there.

For most of us, Word is probably a more logical choice since it allows one to create basic layouts.

Word XP, a part of the recently released Microsoft Office XP suite, allows you to do everything from adding tables, frames and columns to placing images, creating table of contents, spell checking, wrapping text around an object and adding gradients and all of these can be done on the fly.

The things that are required for professional publishing and are missing from Word are support for CMYK, the ability to type text along a randomly drawn path, placement of graphics in frames, masking, etc.

not only provide frames where one can add graphics but also text frames for typing text. Unlike InDesign and Publisher where one has to add text frames to start typing, Frame Maker gives the user the flexibility to type on-screen as well as in text frames. PageMaker and Quark allow the user to type directly without having to place text frames.

Masking: This feature is already present in

most animation and image editing software and is seeing its place in page layout software as well. Going back to the image editing software just to mask objects is boring and disrupts concentration. Now one can easily mask, that is, hide, objects by either placing them one over another or by covering a part of the object with the help of various shape tools so that only a particular portion of that object is visible.

Frame Maker and Publisher have not yet incorporated this feature so one will have to take the trouble of going back to the image editing software for masking images. The remaining software do provide this feature.

Text on path: Advertisements in newspapers where the text flows throughout the page are common. If you think it's difficult to place the text in such a way, you'd be

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